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Lookin' 'EM Over

by JIMMY CALPIN

Parnell, Tunis Recall Great Team of '46

Fredy Seymour, the West Sider who has spent most of his adult years boosting professional baseball, has forwarded this corner a New Orleans paper featuring an article about Scranton, Tiny Tunis, the New Orleans trainer, and former Scranton and Boston Red Sox hurler, Mel Parnell, who will pilot the New Orleans team this year.

Writing in the New Orleans-Picayune, Bob Rossler reported: "Things never were quite the same around Scranton, Pa.," mused Angelo Tunis as he fought to open a giant locker.

Angelo—or do you know him better as Tiny?—was beginning his second tour of duty in New Orleans as trainer for the Pelicans. Tiny, after a two-year hitch with Indianapolis under Walt Cooper, decided to cast his lot with the Pels so he could be nearer his little son (3) Chris, and wife, Mary.

"Coop asked me to return this year, but I decided I'd rejoin the Pelicans after talking with Mr. (president Jack) Defee and Mel Parnell," Tiny explained.

The name of Parnell brought a big smile to the easy-going Tunis' face who was trainer here under Rip Sewell, Danny Murtaugh and Andy Cohen.

"I remember back in '46, when I was working around the park. Mel was pitching there along with Maury McDermott. That club was so strong they dam near wrecked the league. I know one thing Scranton, my old home town, has never been the same. Folks always remembers the great team they had that year."

As Tiny spoke, he went about his business of setting up shop in City Park Stadium. There was much to do between now and when Spring training opens next Monday.

"Yes, Scranton was quite a baseball town then. I remember watching guys like Al Flair, Bo Strickland and Red Lavigne and Parnell. Yep, quite a team," he went on.

Just then Parnell entered and got into the "hot stove" conversation.

"Remember Scranton, Mel?"
we asked.

"I should say I do," Parnell said, and you could see his thoughts fast back 12 years ago.

thoughts fade back 13 years ago. "Most of the guys on our roster were triple-A men. We should have been at Louisville, but the boys were just coming back from the war and Boston farm system had too many top-notch players."

"Scranton was really loaded. I remember we won the pennant by 19½ games and took the playoffs in eight straight," Mel recalled.

The session would have lasted all day, but the phone rang and Parnell got busy with his big job shopping for baseball players.

—shopping for baseball players to open the season with. Tunis, too, had things to do. His training room is always ship-shape, a good tip he picked up at Yankee Gus Mauch's trainers' school some 13 years ago.

So the past was forgotten and all eyes cast to the future.

Looking back in the old record books, we learned Scranton finished the second with a 96-43 record while Albany finished second with 78-62.

Sammy Mele was the league's leading batsman with a .342 average. On the club with Mele and Parnell were: Len Kenesecke, Al Kozar, Sammy Dente, Don Chapman, Danny Carnavale, Merill Combs, Mike Ovaduke, Al Signago, Larry Nowak, Tommy West, Les Aulds Don Palmer, Don Carter, Tommy Fine, Maurice McDermott, Bill Elbert, Jack Tompson.

Parnell won 13 and lost four but Fine compiled the best record in the league 23-3. Parnell's earned run average, 1.30 was the best in the league. Fine's was 2.08. McDermott, just a kid at the time, won 16 and lost 6.

Scranton played before 212,859 paid customers, the third highest in this city's history. The attendance fell to 162,813 the following year and maned to fall off each year until the Miners were forced out of business in '53, when they attracted 62,266.

It's great to recall the fine teams of the past. They are gone but will not be forgotten.